A major classification of planning is done on the basis of societal emphasis by the planning. The type of planning which gives less emphasis upon the social and institutional dimensions is known as the ***normative planning.*** In such planning, the planners just search for the best possible results in relation to the established goals giving less importance to issues like caste, creed, religion, region, language, marriage, family, etc. Opposed to it, the ***systems planning*** gives due importance to the socio-institutional factors. This is a planning from social-technical point of view but only suitable for a country which has lesser degree of social diversities (naturally, not fit for the Indian conditions). But in the coming years there was a shift in the very thinking of the policy-makers. The *Economic Survey 2010-12* is probably the first GoI document which advocates the need for the ***systems approach*** to planning in India. It is believed that until a programme/scheme run by the governments are not able to connect with the customs, traditions and ethos of the population, their acceptability will not be of the desired levels among the target population. Establishing an empathic relationship between the programmes/schemes and target population is now considered as an important aspect of planning and policy-making. Such a change in the thinking is based on the experiences of India and other countries of the world.

Economic planning is classified into more types—***sectoral*** and ***spatial.*** In sectoral planning, the planners emphasise the specific sector of the economy i.e. agriculture, industry or the services. In spatial planning development is seen in the spatial framework. The spatial dimensions of development might be defined by the pressure and requirements of national economic development. Indian planning has been essentially normative—single level economic planning with a greater reliance on the sectoral approach though the multi-level regional or spatial dimensions are being increasingly emphasised since the early 1990s.

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1. S.R. Maheshwari, ***A Dictionary of Public Administration,*** Orient Longman, N. Delhi, 2002, p. 371.
2. ***First Five Year Plan (1951-56),*** Planning Commission, Government of India, N. Delhi, 1991, p. 7.